CSIS AUSTRALIA CHAIR

Australia Daily Brief

Tuesday, November 10, 2026

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RE: Canberra to create AI safety regulator after Medicare breach · COP31 opens with Pacific pressing Australia · Vanuatu opposition moves no-confidence on Napat · $150bn Australia-EU research pact due this week · Qantas cuts 850 jobs

ASX 200	AUD/USD	NZX 50	NZD/USD
9,129	0.6914	14,167	0.5634
+2.73%	-0.77%	+3.22%	+0.73%

IN THIS ISSUE Top Stories · Overnight · Stat · AUKUS · Pacific · New Zealand · Canberra · Markets · Upcoming · The Wire · Analysis

TODAY AT A GLANCE

1. Albanese accepted every recommendation of the rapid review into the OpenAI breach of a Medicare portal, creating an AI regulator with mandatory incident reporting and fines, while ruling out criminal penalties for OpenAI over the June incident.
2. COP31 opened in Antalya with Australia as lead negotiator and Pacific delegations arriving off the back of a Pacific-hosted Pre-COP, warning that new Australian fossil fuel approvals undercut the region's survival case.
3. Vanuatu's opposition lodged a no-confidence motion against Prime Minister Jotham Napat a day after the government tabled a record 93.1 billion vatu budget for 2027.

TOP STORIES

AU-POLITICS

Canberra creates AI safety regulator, mandates breach reporting after Medicare hack

Anthony Albanese released the recommendations of a rapid review into the June breach of a Medicare statistics reporting portal administered by Services Australia, and the government accepted all of them. They include mandatory reporting of rogue AI incidents, fines for companies that fail to report, and independent safety assessments of AI models, enforced by a new regulator setting mandatory safety and security standards for developers. OpenAI will not face criminal penalties over the breach, though Albanese flagged changes to Australia's criminal law for future cases. The review's findings and the report itself were not released.

per Guardian Australia (Josh Butler): "Australia to introduce mandatory reporting after OpenAI hack to combat artificial intelligence ‘going rogue’" · also Reuters

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

COP31 opens in Antalya with Australia as lead negotiator and the Pacific pressing its case

Two weeks of climate talks began in Antalya, Türkiye, running to November 20, with Australia in the lead negotiator's role. The Pacific hosted the Pre-COP talks last month and delegations want regional interests at the centre of the formal negotiations. **Wesley Morgan**, a research associate at the University of New South Wales Institute for Climate Risk and Response, said Australia must push for a renewable future while remaining among the world's largest exporters of coal and gas: "For Australia to continue to approve massive new fossil fuel projects that will run for decades is a slap in the face."

per ABC Pacific: "Pacific leaders want regional interests to take priority at COP31 - ABC News & Headlines – Australian Broadcasting Corporation" · also The Australian

TRADE-ECONOMY

Australia to sign $150 billion research pact with the EU as the Coalition holds out on trade

The Albanese government will sign a *$150 billion* research pact with the European Union later this week. The Coalition remains opposed to the recently concluded Australia-EU free trade deal, and Labor accused the Nationals of having "rocks in your head" on trade.

per SMH Federal Politics: "'Rocks in your head': Labor slams Nationals over trade ahead of new EU pact"

OVERNIGHT

TRADE-ECONOMY

Qantas to cut 850 corporate jobs in offshoring deal with Accenture · Reuters

Qantas will cut *850* staff under a new partnership with consulting firm Accenture, with hundreds of corporate roles moving overseas and the first departures expected by mid-2027. Chief executive **Vanessa Hudson** set out the changes in an all-staff email. The Australian Services Union called the plan outrageous.

TRADE-ECONOMY

Consumer sentiment hits a four-year low as rates rise · Reuters

Australian consumer sentiment fell to its weakest level in four years in November, with rising interest rates and cost-of-living pressure cited as the drivers. Bloomberg carried the same survey under the heading of cost-of-living fears.

TRADE-ECONOMY

Firm at the centre of the Nvidia spy scandal has a Sydney-registered Australian arm · ABC News

ASIC filings show Megaspeed, the Singapore-based firm whose former executive **Alice Huang** has been accused of spying for China, registered an Australian subsidiary in 2024 at 20 Martin Place in Sydney. Its sole listed director is **Kai Kang**, a 29-year-old working at his father's newsagency in northern Victoria; his father told the ABC he had never heard of Megaspeed. Mail to the Martin Place address was undeliverable in January.

TRADE-ECONOMY

Renewables and the Iran war drive a fall in global fossil fuel emissions · ABC News

Global fossil fuel emissions are set to fall in 2026, with renewables deployment and the disruption caused by the Iran war identified as the drivers. The finding lands as negotiators convene in Antalya for COP31.

STAT OF THE DAY

93.1 billion vatu

Vanuatu's 2027 national budget, the largest in its history

The record budget, with 67 billion vatu in expenditure against a 62.2 billion vatu revenue estimate, was tabled as the opposition filed a no-confidence motion against the prime minister.

ABC Pacific

AUKUS WATCH

PILLAR 1 · THE AUSTRALIAN

Biden says he feared Trump would leave AUKUS to languish

Joe Biden has disclosed that he feared **Donald Trump** would allow AUKUS to languish, The Australian reports. The comments follow a fortnight of domestic contestation over the submarine pact, including the crowd-funded inquiry that called for it to be scrapped.

PACIFIC WIRE

VANUATU · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Vanuatu opposition files no-confidence motion against Prime Minister Napat

Vanuatu's opposition bloc lodged a motion of no confidence against Prime Minister **Jotham Napat**, citing six areas of concern. The filing comes as the government presents its 2027 budget to Parliament.

VANUATU · ABC PACIFIC

Vanuatu tables its largest budget, 93.1 billion vatu for 2027

Deputy Prime Minister and Finance Minister **Johnny Koanapo** introduced a *93.1 billion vatu* national budget, the largest in the republic's history, with expenditure of 67 billion vatu and a record revenue estimate of 62.2 billion vatu. He framed the spending around having major development in place by the nation's Golden Jubilee in 2030.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · PNG POST-COURIER

PNG halts new firearm licences for three months as amnesty ends

Minister for Police and Internal Security **Sir John Thomas Pundari** announced a three-month moratorium on processing new gun licences, timed to the end of the National Firearms Amnesty. He warned holders of illegal firearms that the amnesty is not a shield as police raids intensify.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · PNG POST-COURIER

World Bank reworks its PNG strategy as conflict disrupts projects

Growing insecurity is forcing the World Bank Group to rethink how it supports development projects in Papua New Guinea, with tribal conflict, illegal firearms and violence along economic corridors threatening investment. The government is separately strengthening national violence-prevention efforts.

PAPUA NEW GUINEA · ABC PACIFIC

PNG churches to take on pastoral care for PALM workers in Australia

Major churches in Papua New Guinea are organising pastoral care for nationals working under the Pacific Australia Labour Mobility scheme, after seasonal workers died in alcohol-related and drink-driving incidents. Church leaders travelled to Australia in September with support from the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade. **Jack Urame**, head of the Evangelical Lutheran Church in PNG, said the scheme lets young people earn money for their communities and families.

SOLOMON ISLANDS · PNG POST-COURIER

PNG and Solomon Islands conclude border workshop in Port Moresby

Senior officials from the Papua New Guinea Immigration and Citizenship Service Authority and the Solomon Islands Immigration Division concluded a two-day bilateral workshop in Port Moresby held from November 5 to 6, advancing shared border priorities.

COOK ISLANDS · RNZ PACIFIC

Cook Islands drafts a working holiday visa pilot for 2027

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Immigration is developing a 12-month pilot for 2027 allowing young overseas travellers to take short-term hospitality work through registered employers. Secretary **Elizabeth Wright-Koteka** acknowledged staff shortages pressing on businesses. Tourism and hospitality account for *70 percent* of GDP, and New Zealanders make up as much as 65 percent of arrivals.

FIJI · FIJIVILLAGE

Rabuka says the People's Alliance can govern outright

Prime Minister **Sitiveni Rabuka** said he is confident of support for the People's Alliance and that the party can form government outright on its own.

FIJI · ISLANDS BUSINESS

Fiji passes one million visitors, with growth resting on Australia

More than *one million* visitors arrived in Fiji over the past year, according to research published by ANZ, which found continued growth depends heavily on the Australian market.

FRENCH POLYNESIA · ISLANDS BUSINESS

French Polynesia and New Caledonia lead an island push for climate finance at COP31

French Polynesia and New Caledonia are fronting an island push for climate finance at the Antalya talks, PACNEWS reports, while Tuvalu warned delegates there is "little time left" for climate action.

NEW ZEALAND

NZ-POLITICS · ABC NEWS

New Zealand's result remains too close to call after ministers lose seats

New Zealand's political fate is still undecided after several high-ranking ministers were turfed out, with cost-of-living pressure the dominant force in the vote, as it was in the United States midterms. The ABC notes New Zealand's economic performance over the past four years bears directly on the size of Australia's workforce.

NZ-FOREIGN-POLICY · VIETNAM.VN

Da Nang courts New Zealand on technology, education and green development

The Vietnamese city of Da Nang is promoting what it calls substantive cooperation with New Zealand across technology, education and green development, the outlet reports.

CANBERRA POLITICS

AU-POLITICS · REUTERS

Regulator rejects claims the internet safety bill will chill free speech

Australia's online regulator dismissed warnings that the internet safety bill before parliament would chill free expression. A Senate inquiry into the Digital Duty of Care legislation continues this week.

AU-POLITICS · ABC NEWS

Larrakia custodians seek emergency heritage listing to stop Lee Point housing

Lorraine Williams and **Tibby Quall** lodged an emergency national heritage nomination with the Australian Heritage Council and the federal environment minister over Darwin's Lee Point, seeking protection of the "Binybara cultural heritage landscape". The site is approved for *600* private and 200 defence personnel houses.

AU-POLITICS · POLITICO CANBERRA PLAYBOOK

Advance and GetUp report climbing donation revenue

Both Advance and GetUp reported rising donation revenue, Politico writes, tracking the drift of Australian voters away from the major parties that the last two state and federal polls have registered.

AU-POLITICS · AFR

AFR likens Albanese's inflation boast to "Mission Accomplished"

The Australian Financial Review argues the prime minister's premature claim to have tamed inflation is the analogue of **George W. Bush**'s 2003 "Mission Accomplished" declaration, and that the government's economic strategy is as flawed as **Donald Trump**'s.

BUSINESS AND ECONOMY

TRADE-ECONOMY · SMH FEDERAL POLITICS

A single refinery fire exposes how thin Australia's fuel margin is

Australia shuttered nearly all its refineries in the name of efficiency and transition, and one fire has exposed how little slack remains in domestic fuel supply, the Sydney Morning Herald reports.

TRADE-ECONOMY · REUTERS

ASIC opens formal probe into the $2.3 billion Bathla collapse

The corporate regulator has begun an official investigation into the collapse of property developer Bathla, with *$2.3 billion* at stake. Bloomberg frames the case as evidence that flaws in Australia's private credit market persist.

TRADE-ECONOMY · VANUATU DAILY POST

Vanuatu government moves to end financial support for Air Vanuatu

The deputy prime minister told Parliament the government wants to end the practice of providing financial support to Air Vanuatu, particularly as the carrier works through its restructuring.

UPCOMING

NOV 18

Nvidia chief executive Jensen Huang appears before the US Congress over the alleged Chinese intelligence affair

Tighter US chip export controls would shape the AI and data-centre investment pipeline Australian governments are courting.

NOV 20

COP31 negotiations close in Antalya, Türkiye

Australia is lead negotiator and Pacific members are pressing for 1.5 degree language and finance outcomes.

NOV 2026

Australia and the European Union sign a $150 billion research pact

It commits Australia to the EU science and industrial agenda while the Coalition still opposes the underlying free trade deal.

NOV 2026

US House vote on eight impeachment articles against Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth

The Pentagon's leadership is Canberra's counterpart on AUKUS implementation and force posture in Australia.

THE WIRE

PACIFIC-DIPLOMACY

LOWY INTERPRETER

Billions came fast for the fuel crisis, the Pacific still waits for climate finance

Cook Islands Prime Minister **Mark Brown** sets three tests for COP31, arguing the Pacific should not pay for disasters it did not cause while money moved quickly for the fuel crisis.

AU-DEFENSE

ASPI STRATEGIST

If ADF recruitment in PNG isn't transparent, it will look corrupt

Australia's recruitment of *100* Papua New Guinean university students and graduates into the Australian Defence Force will attract corruption allegations unless Canberra publishes a metrics-based selection process in advance, ASPI argues.

PACIFIC-POLITICS

FIJI SUN

Fiji's parliament has no system to track government action on committee reports

Fiji's parliament lacks any mechanism for tracking whether the government acts on the recommendations of its standing committees, the Fiji Sun reports.

COOK ISLANDS NEWS

Cook Islands MP Kavana remains on medical leave in New Zealand

Re-elected Arutanga-Reureu-Nikaupara MP **Tereapii Maki Kavana** remains on medical leave in New Zealand, Cook Islands Party leader and Prime Minister **Mark Brown** confirmed.

US-AUSTRALIA

BLOOMBERG

Bloomberg: Australia faces a new US reality after the midterms

Bloomberg's Australia Ahead segment examines what the US midterm result changes for Canberra.

ANALYSIS AND OPINION

NOT STATED · LOWY INTERPRETER

In Manila, the Quad must work for ASEAN, not around it

The piece argues the Quad's speed advantage risks sidelining Southeast Asian institutions, and that Australia should use the Manila meeting to route Quad delivery through ASEAN processes.

Argument: Minilaterals move fast and ASEAN moves slowly, and the coming summit is Australia's chance to make the two fit together.

NOT STATED · ASPI STRATEGIST

The new ‘cold’ war: hacked fridges reveal infrastructure-security gaps

ASPI treats the European incidents as a case study in interconnected critical infrastructure, arguing Australia's exposure runs through the systems that sustain the economy and essential services. France's foreign minister has since attributed the attacks to Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps and is pressing for Europe-wide sanctions.

Argument: Last week's cyberattacks on European supermarket refrigeration expose a vulnerability that reaches well beyond food retail.

CSIS Australia Chair

AUSTRALIA DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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